targets to be met by the end of the century in core areas of interest such as food, clothing and shelter.

Fifth Summit: Male, 21–23 November 1990

The Heads of the States and Governments reaffirmed their faith and their commitment to the principles and objectives of SAARC. They welcomed the signing of the SAARC Convention on Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances. It was decided to observe 1991 as the Year of Shelter, 1992 as the SAARC Year of Environment, and 1993 as the SAARC year of Disabled Persons. In addition, it was decided to observe the Decade of 1990s as the SAARC Decade of the Girl Child. The Summit also decided to launch the Special SAARC Travel Document, which would exempt its holders from visas for travel within the region.

Sixth Summit: Colombo, 21 December 1991

The Sixth Summit was scheduled for November 1991, but could not be held because of the failure of the member states to arrive at a unanimous decision to hold the Summit in the absence of the King of Bhutan who was unable to attend the Summit due to internal security problems. Ultimately, the seven Heads of States and Governments met for one day at Colombo, on 21 December 1991. The major breakthrough was the approval of the Heads of States and Governments on the establishment of the Inter-Governmental Group (IGG) on the recommendation of the Committee on Economic Cooperation, which had to formulate and seek agreement on an institutional framework under which specific measures for trade liberalization among SAARC member states could be furthered. It was also expected to examine the Sri Lankan proposal to establish a SAARC Preferential Trade Arrangement (SAPTA) by 1997.

Seventh Summit: Dhaka, 10–11 April 1993

The Seventh Summit was postponed twice on account of disturbed situation in Bangladesh in the wake of Babri Masjid demolition in India. Ultimately, it was held in April 1993. The Summit adopted a declaration where the Heads of States and Governments reaffirmed the need to liberalize trade as early as possible. They welcomed the